

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

No.21. 17th June 2024



OUR FOCUS:

The fastest runner doesn't always win the race.

The strongest warrior doesn't always win the battle.

The wise sometimes go hungry.

The skillful are not necessarily wealthy.

The educated don't always lead successful lives.

Time and chance happen to them all. Ecclesiastes 9:11

OUR SCRIPTURE

▲ *Ecclesiastes 9:11 I have observed something else under the sun. The fastest runner doesn't always win the race, and the strongest warrior doesn't always win the battle. The wise sometimes go hungry, and the skillful are not necessarily wealthy. And those who are educated don't always lead successful lives. **It is all decided by chance**, by being in the right place at the right time. NLT*

▲ *Again, I saw that under the sun the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, nor bread to the wise, nor riches to the intelligent, nor favor to those with knowledge, **but time and chance happen to them all. Ecclesiastes 9:11 ESV***

OUR MESSAGE

- * THAT MAN IS SUBJECT TO **TIME** AND **CHANCE** IN RESPECT TO THEIR FUTURE OUTCOMES OF THEIR LIVES.
- * This means that because we do not know what tomorrow will bring forth that it is not man or circumstances or luck or the movement of the stars or some new mystic force that new age presenters promote.
- * So, for the believer in Christ, we conclude that **ONLY** God controls the events of our lives, as he does with those who do not yet know him.

THREE KEY FACTORS OF LIFE

IN OUR VERSE TODAY IT HIGHLIGHTS THREE KEY FACTORS THAT AFFECT THE OUTCOMES AND DESTINY OF THE LIVES OF ALL MANKIND.

FIRSTLY, that we are all subject to time and chance.

SECONDLY, it is not man's environment, circumstances or his attributes (skills) that determines his journey and the outcome of adventures of his life.

It is not the king or the soldier or the horse and their numbers and bravery and skill that delivers the desired outcome – it is what God determines.

▲ **Psalm 33:16-17 - No king is saved by the size of his army; - No warrior escapes by his great strength. - A horse is a vain hope for deliverance; despite all its great strength - it cannot save.**

Psalms 33:11-18 – 11 But the plans of the Lord stand firm forever, the purposes of his heart through all generations. 12 Blessed is the nation whose God is the Lord, the people he chose for his inheritance. 13 From heaven the Lord looks down and sees all mankind; 14 from his dwelling place he watches all who live on earth 15 he who forms the hearts of all, who considers everything they do. 16 No king is saved by the size of his army; no warrior escapes by his great strength. 17 A horse is a vain hope for deliverance; despite all its great strength it cannot save. 18 But the eyes of the Lord are on those who fear him, on those whose hope is in his unfailing love, NIV

THIRDLY, ultimately it is God, not time or luck that determines the ultimate events of people's lives. *He holds in his hands the destiny of every man.*

*** A time for everything**

Ecclesiastes 3:1 There is a time for everything, and a season for every activity under heaven: NIV

*** In God's time he makes everything beautiful**

Ecclesiastes 3:11 He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men; yet they cannot fathom what God has done from beginning to end. NIV

*** Times and seasons are in God's hands**

Daniel 2:21-22 21 He changes times and seasons; he sets up kings and deposes them. He gives wisdom to the wise and knowledge to the discerning. - 22 He reveals deep and hidden things; he knows what lies in darkness, and light dwells with him. NIV

LIFE'S LESSONS TO BE NOTED.

1. THE FASTEST RUNNER DOESN'T ALWAYS WIN THE RACE.

- * It is not always the swifter person who wins the race.

2. AND THE STRONGEST WARRIOR DOESN'T ALWAYS WIN THE BATTLE.

- * And not every battle is won because of a person's strength.
- * **Nor the battle to the strong.**

3. THE WISE SOMETIMES GO HUNGRY.

- * Nor is the wisest have every daily bread / provision supplied.
- * **Nor does food come to the wise.**

4. AND THE SKILFUL ARE NOT NECESSARILY WEALTHY.

- * It is not always the most skilful or gifted person that is rich.
- * **Or riches comes to men of intelligence and understanding.**

5. AND THOSE WHO ARE EDUCATED DON'T ALWAYS LEAD SUCCESSFUL LIVES.

- * **Neither does favor to men of skill.**
- * Not always do the educated knowledgeable and learned are honoured, loved or praised.

6. IT IS ALL DECIDED BY CHANCE, BY BEING IN THE RIGHT PLACE AT THE RIGHT TIME.

TIME = the component that we are all faced with.

- ▲ This is the period in which things happen in our lives and which we do not know what will take place. Unexpected things happen which can challenge or disturb disappoint.
- ▲ Also, some things take time to change, to heal or forgive and things to be reconcile before additional things can take place.
- ▲ We do not know what tomorrow holds.
- ▲ It takes time for somethings to be fully formed – e.g. pregnancy a baby 9 months, gestation period - bird's eggs 21 days, sheep 21 weeks.

CHANCE = The possibility or probability of something happening

- ▲ The uncertainty of what is going to happen - the unpredictable.
- * **IT IS PRESUMPTUOUS OF US TO THINK THAT WE ARE MANAGERS OF THE EVENTS OF OUR LIVES OR TO IMAGINE THAT WE DETERMINE OUR FUTURE OUTCOMES.**
Romans 9:16 It does not, therefore, depend on man's desire or effort, but on God's mercy. NIV

Deuteronomy 8:17-18

17 You may say to yourself, 'My power and my own ability have gained this wealth for me,'

18 but remember that the Lord your God gives you the power to gain wealth, in order to confirm His covenant He swore to your fathers, as it is today. Holman

Zechariah 4:6 "This is the word of the Lord to Zerubbabel: 'Not by strength or by might, but by My Spirit,' says the Lord of Hosts. Holman

A REMINDER FOR ALL OF US

- ▲ **I AM CERTAIN THAT WE ALL ACKNOWLEDGE THE TRUTH THAT GOD IS THE ONE WHO CONTROLS THE AFFAIRS OF MAN AND IT IS HE WHO PROVIDES, DELIVERS AND GIVES US STRENGTH, WISDOM AND COURAGE TO DO CERTAIN THINGS.**
- ▲ **BUT IT IS VITALLY IMPORTANT THAT WE DO NOT MOVE AWAY FROM THAT POSITION BECAUSE TODAY THERE IS A GROWING EMPHASIS EVEN IN THE CHRISTIAN COMMUNITY ON THE BELIEF THAT THE ORDERING AND MANAGEMENT OF MAN'S AFFAIRS IS POSSIBLE THROUGH THE ACQUISITION OF BETTER KNOWLEDGE, MORE WISDOM AND SKILLS.**
- ▲ **HOW WRONG THAT IS. Amen – Ps Barry**